Ollscoil na Gaillimhe
University of Galway

Scoil na Ríomheolaíochta
School of Computer Science

CT101 Computing Systems

Hackathon 2025-2026

Abstracts Booklet

19 Teams

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Team 1

Error but Run

Restaurant Ordering System

THEME
Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS
Aisha Abdulahi, Linyi Zhang, Wei Yuet Lim

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement :

When ordering food in a restaurant, customers may sometimes experience situations where the waiter makes a mistake or misunderstands their order. During peak hours, customers may also face long waiting times because no waiter is immediately available to take their order. These issues can lead to customer dissatisfaction and reduced efficiency in restaurant operations. Using an online ordering system can help to reduce ordering errors, shorten waiting time and improve overall service efficiency.

Proposed Solution :

The aim of this project is to design and develop a simple web-based Restaurant Ordering System that allow customer to browse a digital menu and place food order though a web page. The system will display food item along with images so that users can easily see what the dishes look like. Users will be able to view the list of available food and add items to a shopping cart and confirm their order when ready. Meanwhile, chefs will be able to view orders through the system. The proposed system will be implemented using basic client-server architecture. The front-end of the system will consist of simple web pages developed using HTML and CSS. The back-end will handle user request such as viewing menu, adding items to the cart and submitting orders. Item data will be stored in a simple database or structured file format.

Team 2

Athlone

Smart Laundry Guardian: IoT-Based Weather Alert System

THEME

IoT is Bold

TEAM MEMBERS

Hamza Ahmed, Tom Bourke

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement : Many people dry their clothes outside, but the weather can change very quickly. Sudden rain can soak clothes without warning, meaning they must be washed again or left to dry longer. Weather apps often give general forecasts, but they are not always accurate for one location and don't give instant messages for the user to know when it is going to rain. There is no simple, effective and low costing system that warns people immediately when it is going to rain near their home or area that they are in.

Proposed Solution : The Smart laundry machine is a small IoT system that looks at local weather conditions and alerts the user when it is going to rain or when it is raining. The system uses a small simple Raspberry Pi computer with sensors attached to measure humidity, temperature, and air pressure. These are the main factors to consider when it is going to rain. These stats are collected every few seconds using Python. And keep the user up to date with the weather. This can be used by people doing their laundry at home to not get caught out with sudden rain showers. Also sports coaches can you this software to check the weather to adapt training and game tactics to the weather which is going to occur. This software has multiple other purposes such as farming, preparation for outdoor events such as weddings, concerts ect and soil irrigation. The program looks for changes in the data, such as rising humidity or falling air pressure or change in temperature which often happen before rain. When these conditions are detected, the system sends alerts in two ways: (1) Local alert: A message or light pattern appears on the sensor display alerting the user that rain or other weather is coming. (2)Phone alert: A notification is sent to the user by email or phone over Wi-Fi.The data is saved in log files and shown on a simple web dashboard made with Flask. This dashboard displays graphs so users can see how the weather changes over time. The device can be placed near a window or balcony to get more accurate readings.

Expected Impact: This project shows how IoT can be used to solve a small but real everyday problem. It makes weather monitoring more personal and useful by giving real-time alerts. The system is low-cost and easy to understand, making it suitable for first-year computing students. In the future, the idea could be expanded for uses like garden watering or outdoor event planning.

Team 3

FireTech Innovators

Operation Imagination

THEME
Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS
Simon Balaz, Dhurgam Alsaadi, Nigel Glynn Nee

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

The challenge that we have decided to address is one that relates to the gaming sector. Many games that are made nowadays seem to lack the charisma and charm that their older counterparts oozed with, and we have found issue with this. We hope to make a game that is not only very fun and visually appealing, but also one that is multiplayer so that multiple people can savour the experience together. A simple concept is all that is necessary to bring about endless hours of joy and laughter; with some dedication and hard work, we may yet be able to achieve this. Possible difficulties that will arise will be those of learning how to best work as a team and utilize individual strengths, deciding upon a game concept that we're all passionate about, figuring out how to program and design said game, and probably most difficult of all: how to go about creating the multiplayer server that will host and manage the game.

Proposed Solution:

To tackle this challenge, we'll start out by developing a road map that will help us identify the key obstacles that we need to overcome. This will give us a clear outline of what it is that we need to do and should help keep us motivated and on track. Once that is done, we will begin brainstorming our game and try to gain a more concrete idea of what it is that we're going to do. We will need to discuss different genres, art styles, and what kind of overall atmosphere we would like our game to elicit. We'll then need to decide what it is that each team member will be focusing their efforts on. Following that and having been assigned our areas, we'll break off and start working on our individual pieces, which will entail elements of graphic design, programming and any additional learning and research that is necessary. Meeting as often as needed, we will discuss current progress and any difficulties that have arisen, and how we might solve them. If all goes well, we will meet all our objectives and will come out on the other side with a well-polished and exciting multiplayer game!

Team 4

Jakub Bratos (solo)

Open File Host

THEME

Old is Gold

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

Online websites for temporary file hosting are difficult to trust, with their monetization models involving considerable amounts of advertising, user data collection, or both. It is not uncommon to see data collected by these services to be disclosed to third parties, which can include personally identifiable information. Even accessing or interacting with the service can subject users to being monitored and used for machine learning purposes. Privacy policies can also often use misleading language, such as “Trusted Third Parties”, implying benign intent, but upon further inspection, these trusted third parties typically include companies with significant privacy controversies such as Google 4, Amazon5 and Oracle6. Additionally, these services are centralised and susceptible to inspection by governments and law enforcement7, being at risk from takedowns from registrars for non-compliance and DNS blocking, as examples. Files are also commonly left unencrypted. The practical problem therefore is, how can we have a temporary file host accessible with just a normal internet connection, while maintaining as much privacy, security and freedom as possible?

Proposed Solution:

A Linux computer starts a temporary ipv6 server restricted to a single directory by apparmor at port 8080, protecting the existing system even if the running server gets compromised. A self-signed certificate is made to provide HTTPS as DNS is unavailable here (Yes, this will result in browser warnings). A maximum storage capacity can be chosen for uploads. A client connects to this address and is served a web interface to upload files with options to encrypt their files before uploading to the server. This is in case the user behind the client and the server is not the same, as then the server administrator will have free access to the uploaded file. The file, if desired, is encrypted client side with a password, with a random salt added to the encryption process that is stored on the server for the given file, until it is deleted. The user can also choose to let the server know the f ile type and other data such as file name to display beforehand for anyone wanting to download the file. The user is then given the URL for the uploaded file, which is randomised and persists until it is either automatically deleted as defined in the server configuration or by the user themselves. Any user with the URL can download the encrypted file or decrypt it client side if they have the correct password. The server will not be able to verify if the password was correct. For unencrypted files, the server will try to automatically detect file type by checking common file signatures 8. The server will always display the file size and date uploaded.

Team 5

JackAces

Web Server type 7 (chat server)

THEME

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Norbert Stepak, Dylan Brennan, James Burns

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

For several years, there has been a constant problem that people in the IT sector have repeatedly faced. That problem is proper communication. These issues result in files not being allowed to be sent on certain applications or slow server response times. There is always an issue hindering the process of sending messages and showing off any home projects. People can become frustrated based on these inefficiencies. We have seen an increase in the number of people who want a messaging site that is reliable, quick, and, of course, private. The community has grown tired of waiting for a messaging site that is made specifically with developers in mind. That is why, as a team, we are building a messaging server tailored for people working in this sector. The problems that we plan to face are user-friendly interfaces, a fast, responsive website, and a way for users to express themselves.

Proposed Solution:

To solve the first problem, we will design a simple, minimalistic interface in HTML, with accessibility and ease of use as major priorities. We will use CSS for the design of it. For a fast, responsive website, we will use WebSocket to connect all the computers to a single server to allow for real-time, fast responses between users. To allow users to express themselves, we will be using elements of popular online apps such as X and Discord to allow users to showcase any recent developments in their IT journey. We want to make sure that we do not overcomplicate the design of the messaging server, as it may ruin the experience for the users.

Team 6

The Phoques

Sealio - Web Server 3: Media Streaming Server

THEME

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Dominik, Sarah, Finnán

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

In today's streaming service world, you need to be subscribed to a multitude of expensive streaming platforms just to watch all the movies and TV shows you want to watch, and that quickly adds up to a huge monthly subscription cost. Instead of feeling convenient, streaming has become fragmented and frustrating, with different services competing for exclusivity and splitting content across multiple paywalls. On top of the price, many platforms are also continuously making the user experience worse over time, not better. Lower tiers are beginning to include ads, basic features get locked behind more expensive plans, and even things like higher resolutions or better audio are treated like "premium perks" instead of standard quality. As a result, users are paying more while getting less control, less simplicity, and a less enjoyable viewing experience overall.

Proposed Solution:

A website that gives access to our database of videos with NO subscription cost, designed to prioritise user experience rather than profitability. Users can browse and search for content and start streaming straight away through a clean, responsive player with key features. On the backend, the library is stored and organised in a structured way, plus an upload area so new videos can be added, edited, and organised easily as the database grows. Overall, the goal is a fast, consistent, simple to use, distraction free experience with no ads, upselling, or unnecessary distractions. Just straightforward access to content in one place.

Team 7

Pints++

Student Survival - Web Server Type 1

THEME
Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS
Christina Grant, Lucy Grant

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

New students are often overwhelmed and often struggle to adjust to the university and the demands of the computer science course. Many new students are unsure of how to prioritize in the first weeks of university. It can be a very overwhelming experience and may cause students to feel lost or behind in regards to where they are in the computer science program.

Proposed Solution:

Easy to navigate website that is used as informational support. It will focus on essential information and guidance for first year computer science students which highlight practical guides anywhere from preparation for exams to lab sessions. It will also have a structured checklist for the first weeks of the course and will also provide information in regards to campus supports.

Team 8A / 8B

Lizards of the Roast

Untap Upkeep Draw (UDD for short)

THEME
Old is gold

TEAM MEMBERS
Matthew Conroy, Brendan Egan, Ian Fogarty, Thibault Wysocinski

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

A certain card game has been making waves in the GY350 course known as Magic: the gathering (also known as mtg). The game has gained popularity among students. One small problem, however, is that the game traditionally requires players to be physically present in order to play, while this helps foster community and face-to-face interaction, it also creates significant barriers for students with busy schedules, limited transportation, or conflicting commitments. While online options for playing mtg do exist, they are often either heavily restricted or designed around pay-to-win mechanics. Many digital platforms place essential cards, features, or competitive modes behind costly microtransactions, giving paying players a clear advantage. This approach undermines the core values of the game, which are meant to reward strategic thinking, creativity, and player skill rather than financial spending. Beyond monetization issues, several online versions struggle to faithfully recreate the full mtg experience. Simplified rule sets, missing formats, and poorly designed interfaces can make gameplay feel incomplete. These shortcomings may discourage new players from learning the game while frustrating experienced players who expect depth and accuracy. Consequently, there is currently no truly accessible, affordable, and fully featured online option for students to play mtg. This lack of an inclusive digital platform restricts participation, slows community growth, and creates an unnecessary gap between those who can play in person and those who cannot.

Proposed Solution:

Our goal is to see how well we can recreate the experience of playing Magic: the gathering on a digital medium without restrictions or pay to win features. We hope to really challenge ourselves and make sure to implement it with as much fidelity to the original game as possible. To do this we will use a pre existing web server to run UDD and give players an enjoyable experience with a good performance. We intend to use cpp and lua for this project. By open sourcing key components and documenting decisions, we invite collaboration and scrutiny. Our ultimate aim is not monetization, but preservation, experimentation, and joy. We hope for this to be a faithful, accessible place to experience Magic exactly as intended for future players everywhere and generations ahead. In addition, networking will be a core focus of the project. The networking layer will be designed to handle real-time interactions such as priority passing and stack resolution. We aim to support smooth gameplay, future client experimentation, and long-term maintainability.

Team 9

Hackathon Tonight, Queen?

We, The Consumer

THEME

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Misia D, Willow H

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

With every day that passes, online video streaming becomes more and more of a nightmare with data harvesting, AI content, adverts every five seconds, poor moderation, paywalling, and the algorithm pushing creators to only make content that caters to the majority while ignoring smaller demands for more niche types of content. Sites like YouTube have a monopoly when it comes to consumer-created content and has an easier time staying on top due to it being owned by a bigger and richer corporation like Google.

Proposed Solution:

We will attempt to solve this issue by making a video hosting server which will allow users to upload their own videos. We will host this server using old P.C.s. We will add options for playing audio when the device's display is off, skipping specific chosen sections on videos based off of community timestamps (which can be toggled), optional onscreen comments as well as comments made at specific points, lyrics for music and subtitles for video with changeable fonts to be dyslexia/blindness friendly, and adjustable video quality/bandwith usage.

Team 10

Shebang

A marketplace dedicated to Students and Uni Campus

THEME

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Karol Hrycyna, David Safo-Ankoma, Kelly Ebalu

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

A marketplace is a reasonable and doable project for this Hackathon. It incorporates many creative solutions and would create a completely new service which solves real issues.

What problem we are solving: Students are often left with a lot of study resources and other items that they don't need anymore. This website would allow them to put those items on sale and they would make some money back, and buying students will be able to get the resources for cheaper. The offers wouldn't get lost among other, unrelated offers like on eg. Facebook marketplace. Other students can easily access the school-related offers and find necessary resources. Buying used items is ecological and cheaper than getting new ones, when it comes to study resources, those do not really lose on quality with use..

Proposed Solution:

Application Server: A web app that allows the user to make an account, post offers of products with pictures, description, price and contact details. The user can also search offers, filter by category, add to favorites and contact other users via in-built chat.

Team 11

TheBurritoByters

PlanMyStudy

THEME

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Linu George and Ian Gallagher

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

Many students like ourselves struggle to track and manage assignments across multiple modules, which can lead to missed deadlines, incomplete work, and falling behind academically.

Proposed Solution:

This project aims to fix this problem by developing a web-based study planner that helps students organise assignments and plan their study schedules in one location. The system will include a customisable calendar that allows users to create, update, and manage their study plans. A key feature of the platform is its collaborative functionality, allowing multiple users to share calendars and edit them together. We intend to use an old device to make a local server to run our web-based application.

Why is it useful? This is a very practical website and tool, which will be useful to students that feel under pressure by the large amounts of work. This tool will be easily accessible as it will a website, which many students can access through their respective devices.

Team 12

Rubus Labs

FloraGuard: Intelligent Environmental & Soil Health Monitor

THEME

PI the IoT (IoT is Bold)

TEAM MEMBERS

Izabela Heczkova, Hurrain Ghaffar, Irene Kellegher

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement: In today's busy lifestyle, it is becoming increasingly difficult to monitor the progress of our plants and their physical states due to constant changes in their environments. Indoor gardeners and enthusiasts often struggle with the "invisible" health metrics of their plants. While a plant might look healthy externally, subtle fluctuations in ambient temperature and humidity, combined with inconsistent soil moisture levels, can cause irreversible strain on plant health before physical symptoms appear, leading to plant failure due to delayed responses to environmental changes. Neglecting to respond to these environmental changes in real-time can be detrimental to sensitive flora.

Proposed Solution: We propose FloraGuard, an integrated embedded system built on the Raspberry Pi and Sense HAT. Our solution will leverage the Sense HAT's onboard temperature and humidity sensors to monitor the plant's immediate atmosphere. Using Python, we will develop a monitoring script that:

Analyses Data: Interprets real-time environmental data against pre-defined optimal thresholds for specific plant species.

Visual Feedback: Utilizes the 8x8 LED Matrix to provide instant status updates (e.g., a Green icon for optimal conditions and Red for temperature spikes).

Data Logging: Stores hourly readings in a CSV format on the Raspberry Pi to allow for long-term health trend analysis. This allows our team to generate statistical summaries and graphs to identify long-term growth patterns.

Security & Surveillance: We will integrate the Camera Module v3 to capture photos when significant environmental changes are detected, creating a visual log of the plant's reaction to stress

Team 13

Paranoid Androids

Game Server – Multiplayer System

THEME
Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS
Padraig Haverty, Mark Whitworth

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

We must design a client that manages:

- game sessions with real-time player synchronization
- player authentication o game state updates
- matchmaking
- persistent progression

Proposed Solution:

We aim to deliver a functional proof-of-concept multiplayer system with a working browser client, fully implemented matchmaking, secure authentication, and persistent player progression. We will be designing this client using:

- Rust for backend services
- JavaScript for a browser-based POC client
- WebSockets and REST for communication
- PostgreSQL and Redis for data storage
- Docker for containerization
- Prometheus for monitoring

Team 14

BikePi

PiCycle

THEME
"IoT is Bold"

TEAM MEMBERS
Charles Hayes, Christopher Salermo, Michael Yore

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

In recent years, technology has been developed to solve problems in various areas of our lives. This serves to improve our lives, making them easier and more convenient. However, despite all these advancements and applications, one popular activity has been neglected: Cycling. Cycling is difficult. There's no doubt that cyclists face several challenges daily. For instance, it's vital for safety that cyclists know and are aware of weather conditions as well as visibility levels ahead of and during their journey. Navigating can also be problematic as their hands cannot be free to use a phone or a map and compass. For many cyclists it's important to know the details of their journey including the distance travelled, their average speed and the approximate number of calories they've burned, for example.

Proposed Solution: Weather conditions /temperature - We will use the temperature sensor on the Sense Hat to measure surrounding temperature, the humidity sensor to measure surrounding humidity levels and display these figures on the 8x8 RGB LED Matrix.

Daylight - the color and brightness sensor can indicate whether it is bright enough to safely cycle with or without the appropriate head and taillights on the bicycle. Turning these on and off at the appropriate times will both contribute to safety and power saving

Orientation/navigation - We will use the magnetometer as a compass to measure direction, which will be displayed using the respective direction arrows in the LED Matrix.

Acceleration – the accelerometer can be used to help show if the cyclist is maintaining their current speed or not by using color on the Sense HAT to indicate whether the cyclist is accelerating or decelerating.

Safety – if the accelerometer detects a sudden change in acceleration (e.g. a crash) the last minute of footage taken by the camera will be saved . The camera will record the first minute of the start of the journey (when the accelerometer detects a change in stationary acceleration) and the last minute of the end of the journey in a time-lapse when the acceleration stops. Journey times will also be displayed using a stopwatch on the LED screen, and the recording will start and end manually via the joystick (although the recording will be paused when the acceleration stops).

Team 15

8 Ball

A web-based platform for the sport of Pool (cue sports)

Theme

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Tanvir Patwary and Quillan Matthews

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

The core idea behind our project is to build a central hub where users can access real-time and historical information about the world of pool. The website will provide key statistics on well-known professional players, both past and present, allowing users to explore player performances, rankings, and achievements. In addition, users will be able to view live score updates, match results, and upcoming fixtures across multiple levels of competition, including club-level events and international tournaments. This introduces the computing aspect of handling dynamic data, structured databases, and real-time information display.

Proposed Solution:

A major focus of our system is user experience and accessibility. We aim to design a clean, easy-to-navigate interface so that users of all ages and technical abilities can use the platform without difficulty, which will ultimately broaden our target market. From a systems perspective, this involves organising data efficiently, ensuring fast load times, and creating a responsive design that works across different devices such as phones, tablets, and desktops. Another key feature of our website will be a merchandise section, where users can browse and purchase pool-related items such as cues, accessories, and player or team-themed products. While this may be a made-up store for the purpose of the project, it demonstrates how computing systems support e-commerce functionality, including product listings, user interaction, and structured data management. Beyond the technical side, our project also has a social aim. In today's world, many people spend large amounts of time on their phones, often on social media. We want to use technology in a more positive way, not just for entertainment, but to encourage interest in a real-world activity. Pool is a highly skill-based, social, and enjoyable sport, but it does not always receive as much attention as other sports. Through our platform, we hope to raisemore positivelyre people discover the game, potentially encouraging them to take it up as a hobby. This promotes a healthier balance between digital and physical activities.

Overall, our hackathon project combines sport, technology, and user-focused design. By bringing together live data, player statistics, competition information, and interactive features in one system, Team 8 Ball aims to demonstrate how computing systems can be used to inform, engage, and positively influence users while showcasing practical web development and data handling skills.

Team 16

Pocket Aces

A website to play Poker – MultiUser

THEME
Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS
Kamil Matysik, Arnas Perevičius

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

The members of our group enjoy playing poker, however there are three problems with this that we want our project to address, one is needing to be in person and the inability to play well remotely, another issue is getting the equipment for poker, as one needs cards, chips and a proper table to play on which in many cases can be expensive and the last reason is the need to spend money as we should be able to play solely for fun, without needing to risk money. We hope to create a fun experience for users, without the need to spend money, as well as being able to play with your friends instead of random people online as many existing websites do.

Proposed Solution:

We will create a website where multiple users can join each other in rooms, where they will be able to play poker together. They will be able to do all the actions that one can do in a regular poker game, such as betting (virtual chips with no monetary value), folding and so on. A program integrated into the website will be used to decide who has the best hand, and they become the winner of that round. Players will be allowed to join lobbies and invite others without the need to pay any service fees or needing any equipment apart from a modern device with an internet connection. The server should be able to handle multiple separate games ongoing simultaneously, where no game has any affect on other games at all.

Team 17

De Biles

Open Your Window

THEME

IoT is Bold

TEAM MEMBERS

Illia Uriupin, Maksym Potushynskyi

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

As a programmer, I know how important it is sometimes to “touch the grass,” but it is equally important to maintain healthy conditions inside the room. For example, if your room is 12 m², 22 °C, and there is one person in the closed room, the relative humidity (RH) will rise by an average of about 8.8% per hour. Over time, this can cause several problems: increased moisture, health issues, and even corrosion of electronic devices.

Proposed Solution:

So, what solution do we suggest at this point? - Open your window! But when? And for how long? - That is exactly what our project is about. If your RH is too high, a Raspberry Pi 4 with a Sense HAT will track the absolute humidity (AH) inside the room and compare it to the AH outside to make the optimal decision about opening the window.

Our goal is to create a system that not only monitors and maintains healthy indoor humidity levels but also provides a clear, interactive, and engaging way for users to understand their room environment and take timely action, while ensuring the project is extensible for solving real-life problems and that its complete code will be openly available on GitHub at https://github.com/De-Biles.

Team 18

HTK Studio

Tertrai

THEME

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Himika Choudhury, Kamile Laurinaviciute, Andrew Thomas Sweeney Warren

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

Many beginners struggle to understand how machine learning can be used in real and interactive applications - even for simple ones, like a game of Tetris! The challenge is to create a game system where machine learning can be applied in an easy and practical way. This project addresses that challenge by building a Tetris game server that incorporates modern innovations of artificial intelligence and machine learning, in which you can play against a computer model in a game of Tetris.

Proposed Solution:

The hardware we will be using will consist of the PC provided to us by the university for running the server. While the software applications we will be using mainly is an integrated development environment (IDE) to write all our code. We are also using GitHub to share our work with one another. While “old is gold”, we believe that by combining contemporary, current-day elements into retro technology, we are improving the experience, and keeping the game alive in our modern day, in our own way.

Team 19

Golden Archive

Mini Document Search Engine

THEME

Old is Gold

TEAM MEMBERS

Oiza Raissa Chimamanda Dania, Vihaan Prabakaran

ABSTRACT

Problem Statement:

In academic environments such as universities, students and staff often struggle to efficiently find specific information across large amounts of documents such as lecture and research notes as well as course materials; manually searching through a lot of files is very time consuming and frustrating so a faster and more efficient way to retrieve information from documents is needed.

Proposed Solution:

My team proposes creating a mini document search engine that will allow users to quickly search through collection of files. The users will be able to type in a keyword for example “python tutorial” and instantly be shown files with relevant information with text previews. The website will also allow downloading or opening the desired files. The website will be developed using python programming and HTML and CSS for the website design and graphics.